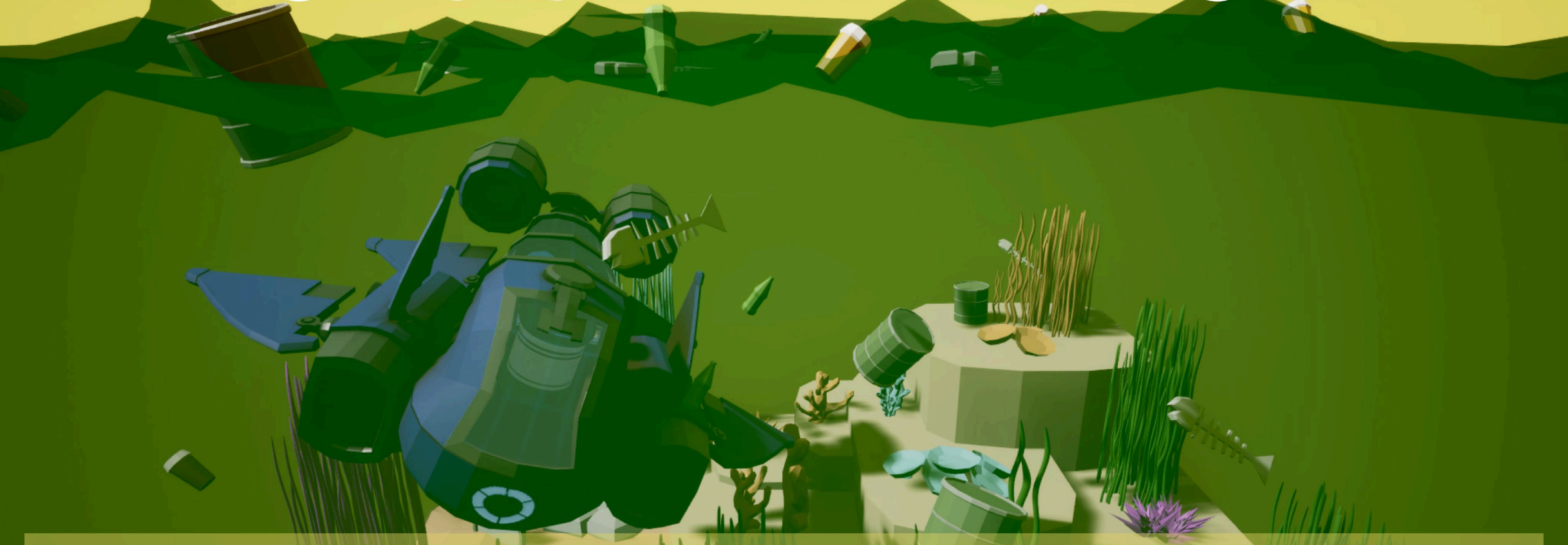
THE OASIS AMID THE OCEAN



This project is a 3D visual scene created based on Unreal Engine 5. Through the combination of exquisite modeling and dynamic lighting and shadow effects, it creates a virtual environment full of contrasts and metaphors. The protagonist of the scene is a clean, beautiful and greenery-filled small boat, which seems like a self-sufficient oasis, slowly moving forward on a polluted sea surface that is dirty and filled with dead fish and rotten marine creatures.

This small boat symbolizes the "ideal living environment" constructed by humans, orderly and green, but it forms a strong visual and emotional contrast with the fragmented natural ecology around it. Through this extreme contrast, the project satirizes the contemporary society where humans only focus on the cleanliness and comfort of their own lives, often turning a blind eye to the destruction and deterioration of the larger environment - nature.

The entire work is not merely a visual presentation, but also a metaphorical and critical exploration of environmental issues. By leveraging the immersive nature of virtual reality, it prompts the audience to reconsider the relationship between humans and nature: If our "oasis" is built on the neglect of the outside world, how long can it last? This small scene is a questioning of modern environmental ethics and an artistic response to anthropocentrism.

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INSPIRATION

The inspiration for this project came from a scene I witnessed during a seaside trip. On a beach scattered with trash and dead fish, a pair of tourists lay on their own lounge chairs. Beside them were potted plants, scented candles, and carefully decorated drinks. It was as if they had transported a small, idealized personal space into a ruined reality, remaining completely indifferent to the surrounding pollution.

At that moment, I was struck by a powerful sense of dissonance. Humanity seemed capable of constructing a private "oasis" against a backdrop of environmental collapse, while simultaneously turning a blind eye to the degradation of the real world.

This experience led me to reflect on whether our obsession with "ecology" or "green living" is confined to small, self-centered spatial adjustments. If environmentalism is reduced to balcony plants and aromatic interiors, rather than a genuine respect for and restoration of the planet's ecosystem, then what are we truly protecting—nature itself, or merely an illusion of it?

Based on this reflection, I created a 3D scene: a clean, plant-filled boat drifting across a sea polluted with waste and death. The image functions both as satire and as metaphor, revealing humanity's tendency to escape from ecological crises and its superficial understanding of what "sustainable living" truly means.

The Symbolic Meaning of the Boat, "The Personal Oasis" and Human Self-Interest
The concept of smallness is deliberately emphasized. The boat is not merely a small vessel, but resembles a refined human-made object—almost a high-tech ecological capsule. It is carefully designed to be visually pleasing, comfortable, and filled with lush green plants and clean air, representing an idealized micro-environment imagined by humans.

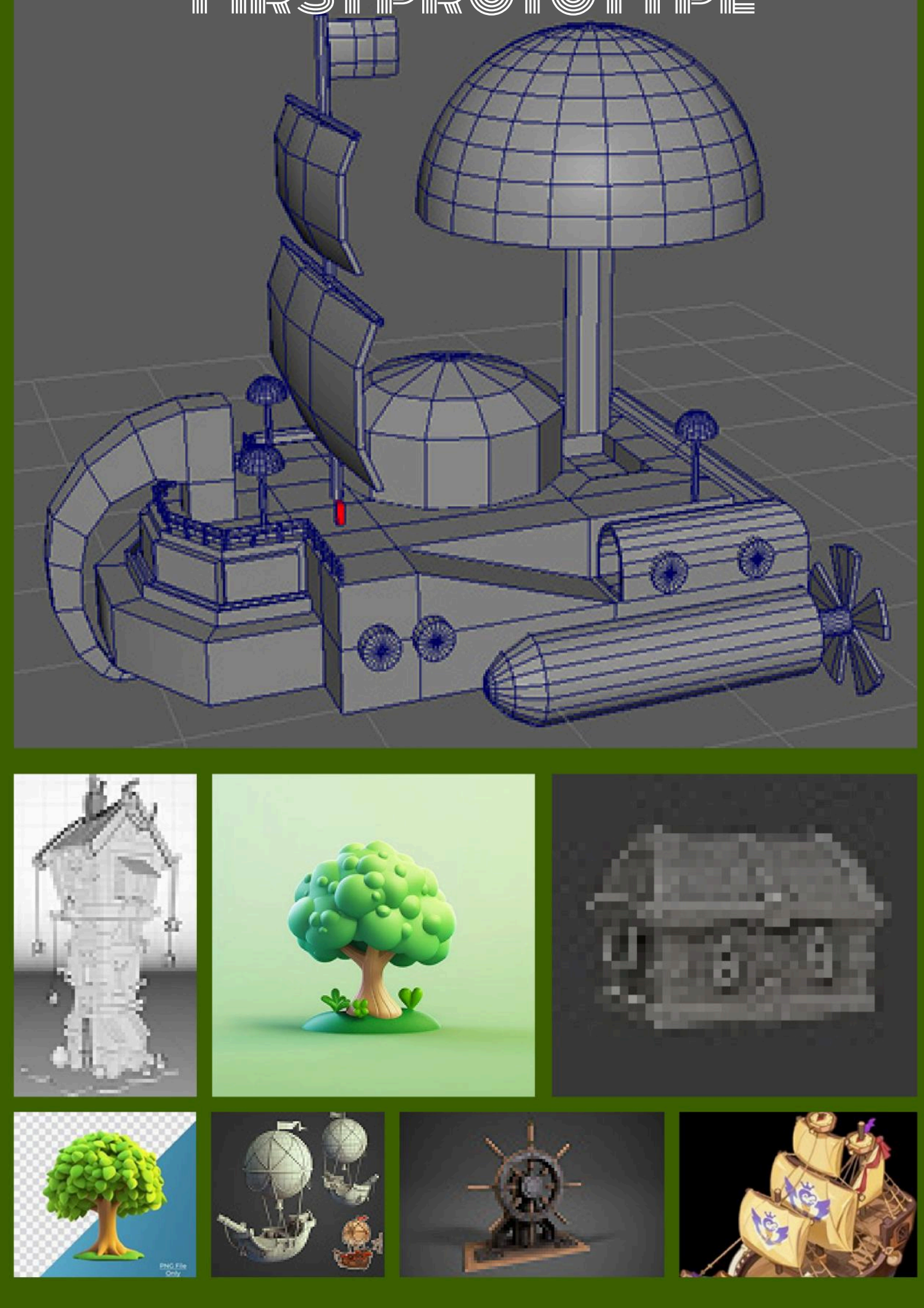
This boat is private and exclusive. It functions as a personal shelter constructed to escape the harsh conditions of the external world. Those on board can remain elegantly dressed and continue to enjoy the artificial "nature" provided within the boat, completely isolated from the polluted and decaying surroundings.

By foregrounding its personal nature, the work highlights the artificiality of this self-contained ecosystem. The stark contrast between the boat's cleanliness and beauty and the surrounding environmental degradation exposes a form of self-deception. It satirizes humanity's tendency to prioritize comfort within a limited personal space while ignoring the deterioration of the larger ecological system—a mentality of "out of sight, out of mind."

Detailing the Polluted Sea Surface
Diverse Forms of Pollution--The filth covering the sea surface should not be limited to dead fish and decaying marine life. Additional elements such as industrial waste, plastic debris, oil slicks, and chemical pollutants can be introduced to more comprehensively convey the severity and complexity of ocean pollution.
A Visual Sense of Decay--The depiction of dead fish and marine remains can be rendered with greater specificity—bloated bodies, hollow and lifeless eyes, decomposing limbs, and floating organs or skeletal fragments. These details intensify the visual impact and discomfort, allowing viewers to directly confront environmental decay and the disappearance of life.
Implied Smell and Sound--Although the work takes the form of a 3D scene, descriptive text can be used to suggest the nauseating stench rising from the polluted water, as well as the desperate cries of seabirds or, conversely, an oppressive and unnatural silence. By engaging multiple senses through implication, the work deepens the tragic atmosphere of ecological collapse.

VERSION-1

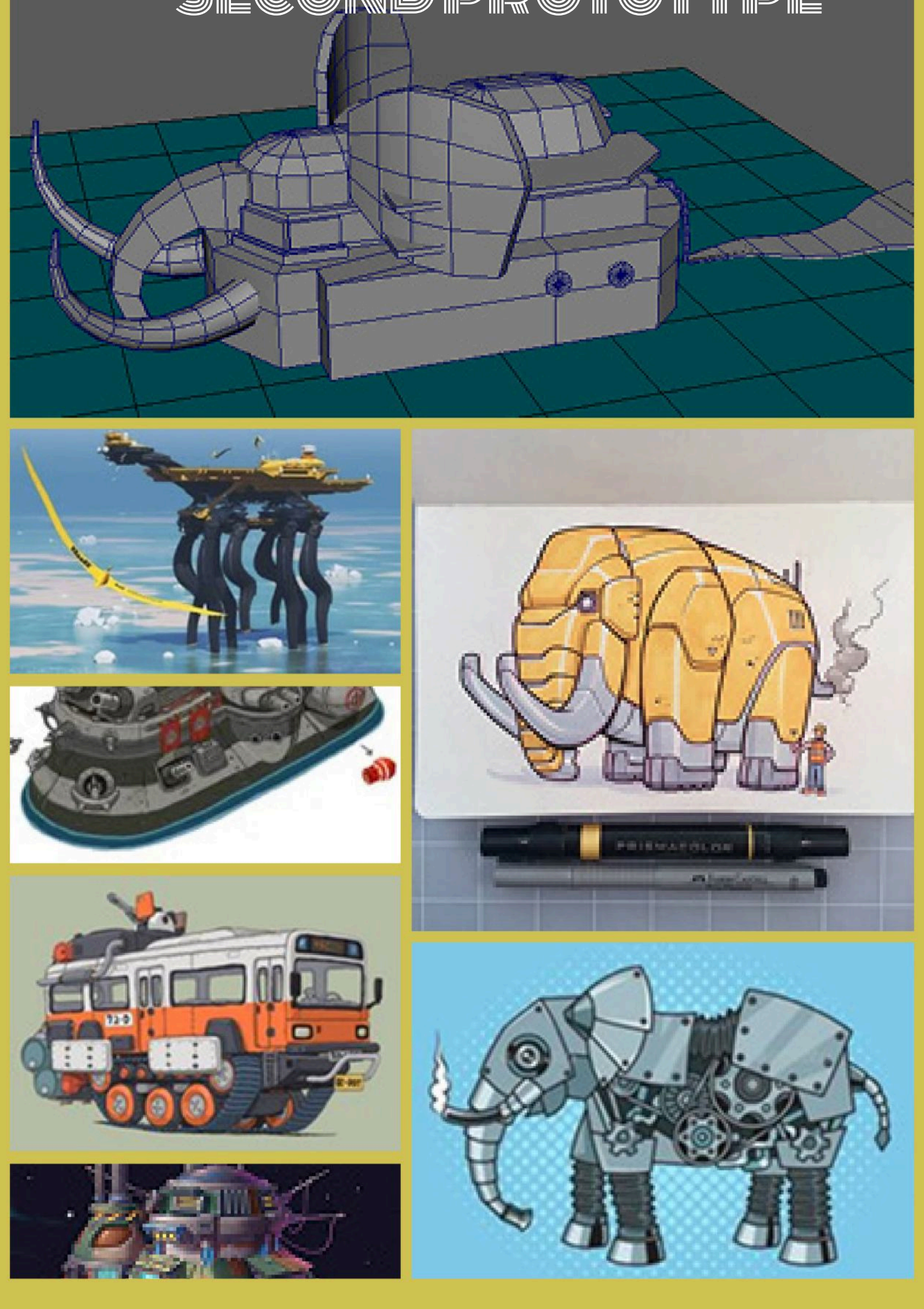
FIRST PROTOTYPE



First prototype (Island): Focuses on portraying humanity's insignificance. Its weakness lies in its overly isolated atmosphere and lack of inter-organismic connection.

VERSION-2

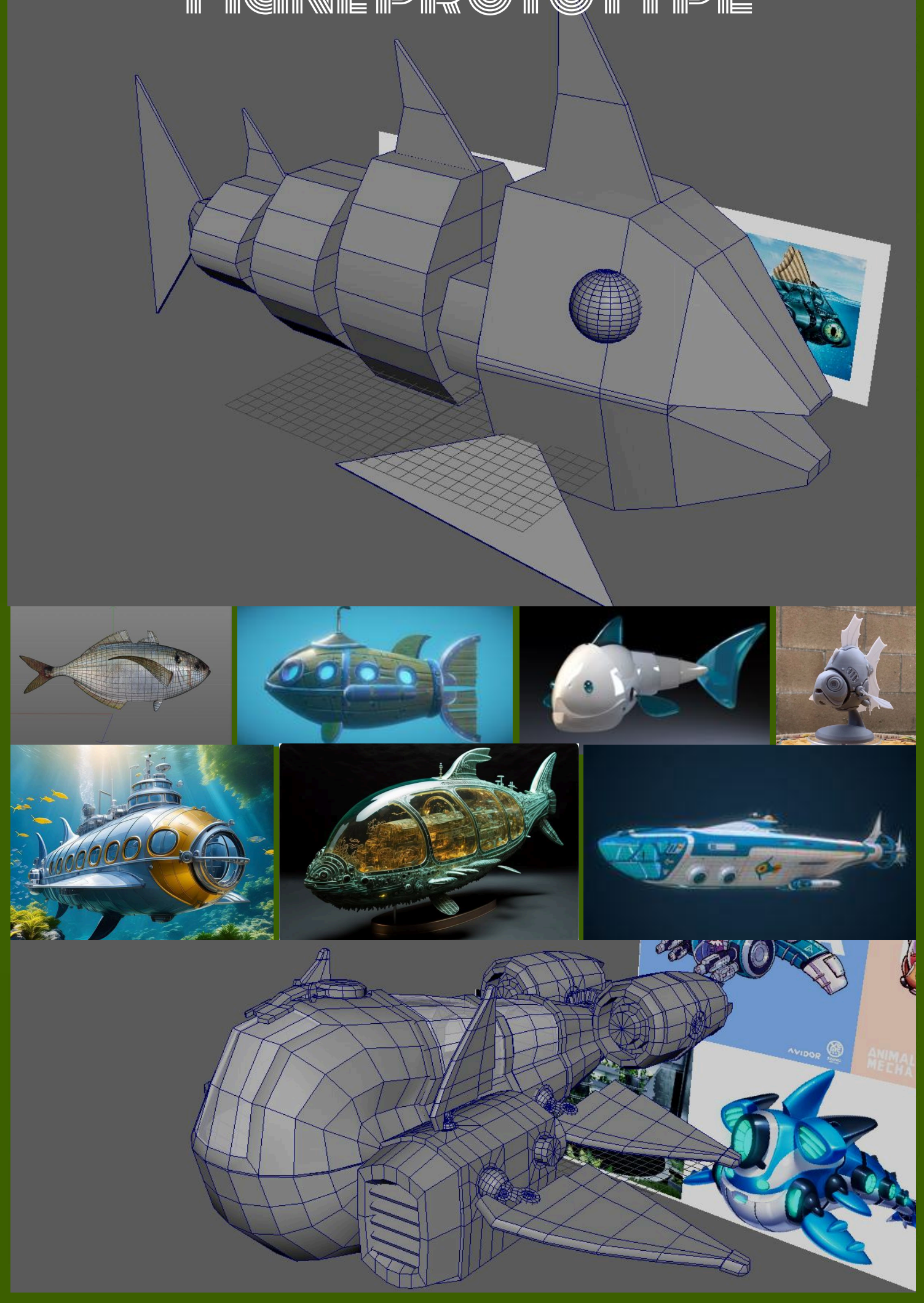
SECOND PROTOTYPE



Second prototype (Elephant): Attempts to introduce land-based behemoths to enhance the sense of life. Its weakness is the clash between biological attributes and the marine environment, resulting in a jarring visual presentation.

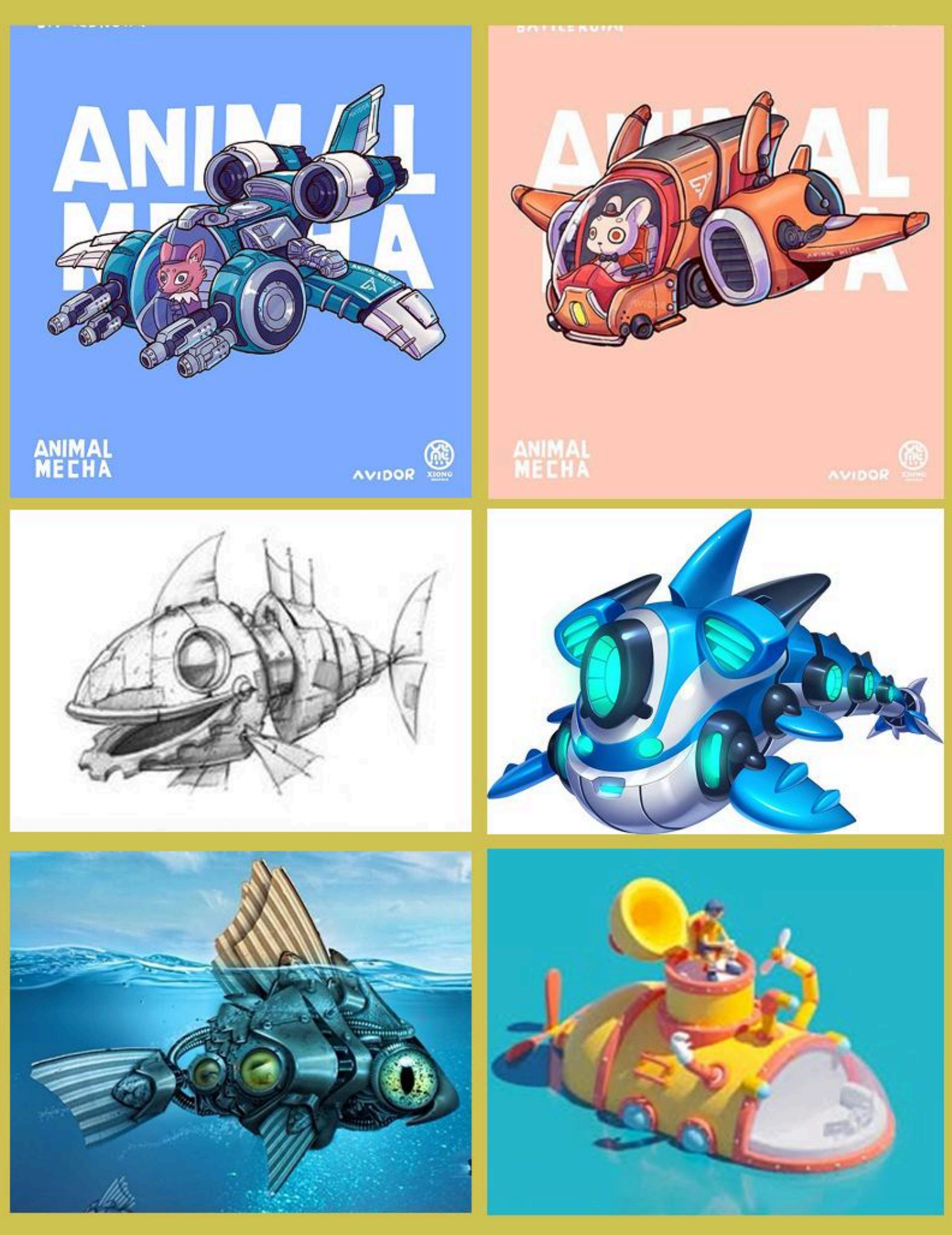
VERSION-3

FIANL PROTOTYPE



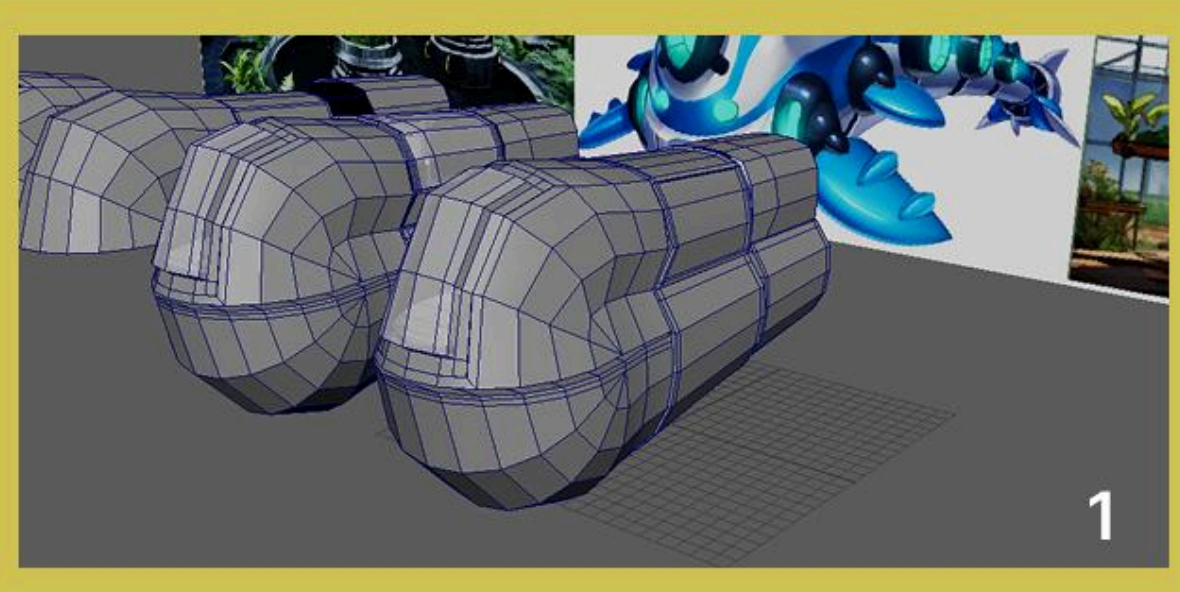
Third prototype (Fishboat): Returns to marine imagery, employing a design combining biomimetic fish and mechanical structures. Through the collision of biological and industrial aesthetics, it expresses humanity's ambition and contradictions in attempting to conquer the sea using technology.

REFERENCE



Made in MAYA

FISH-THE OASIS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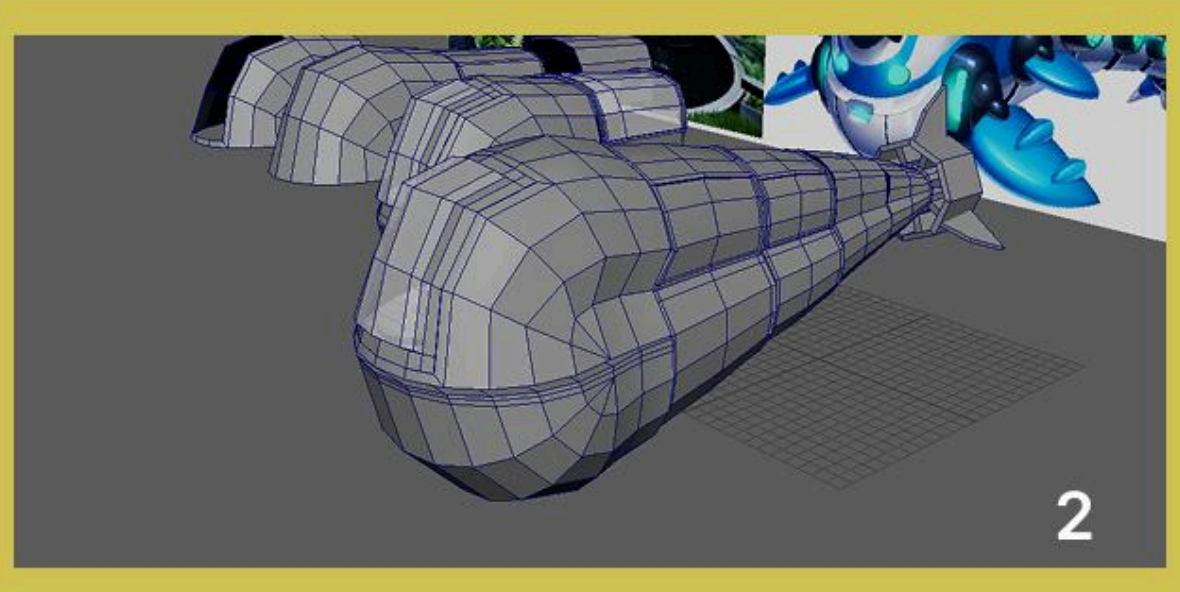
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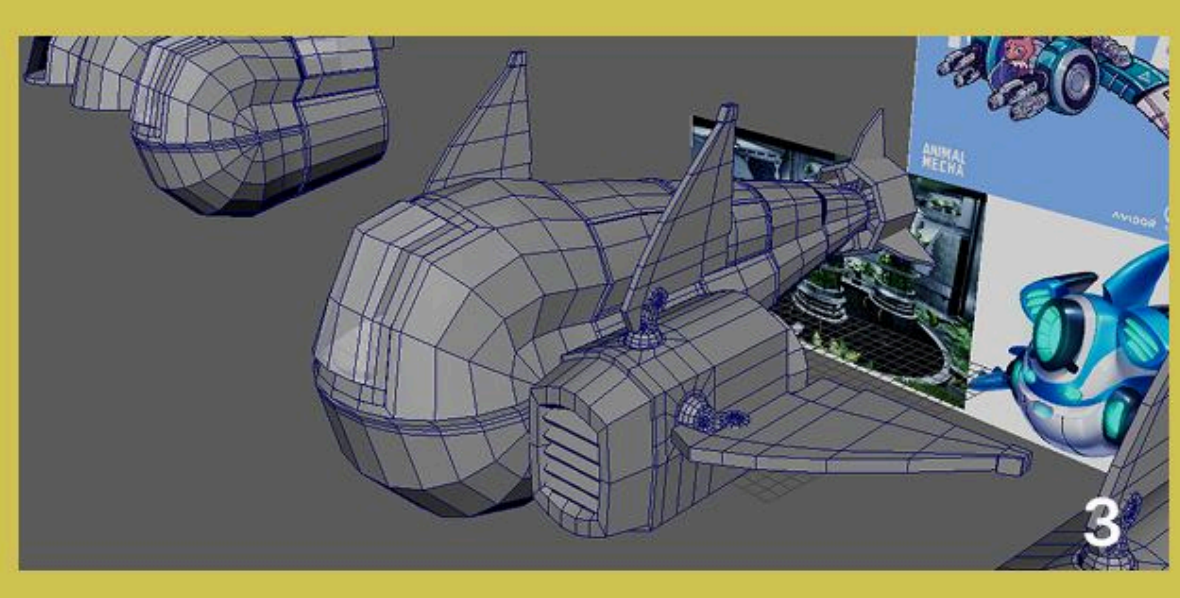
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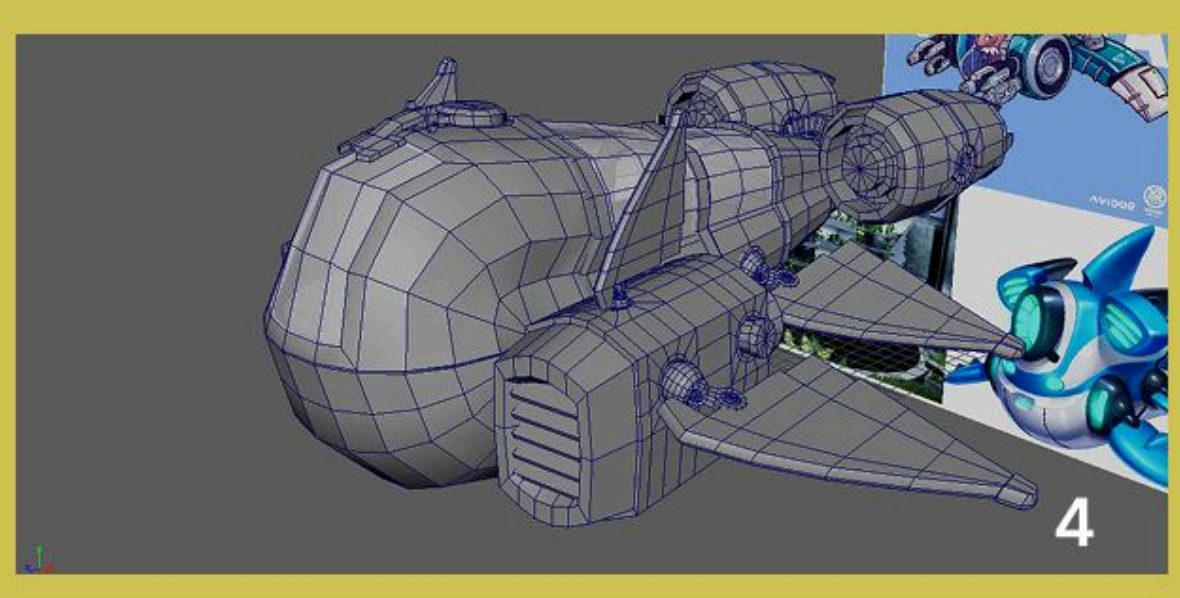
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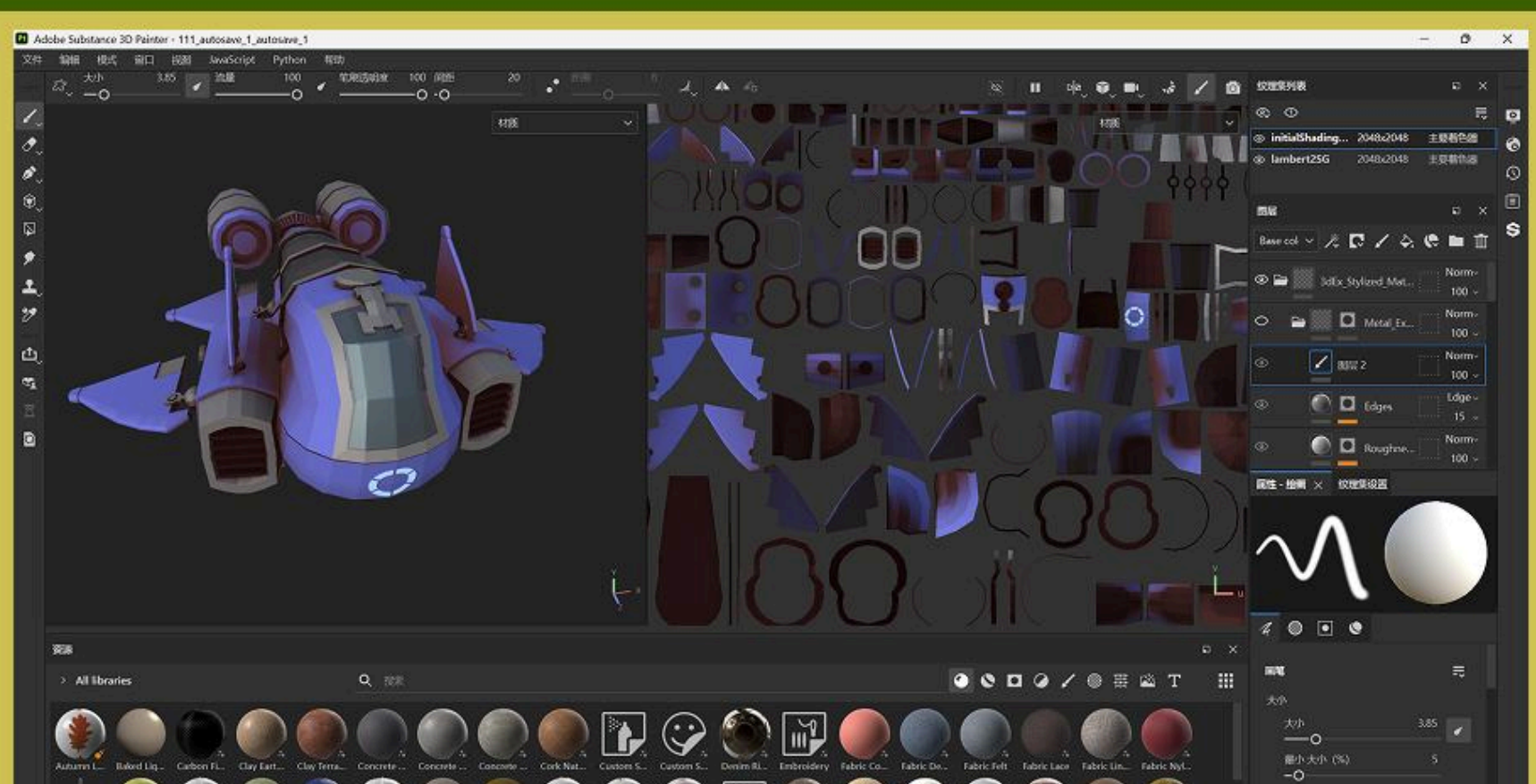
Textured in Substance Painter



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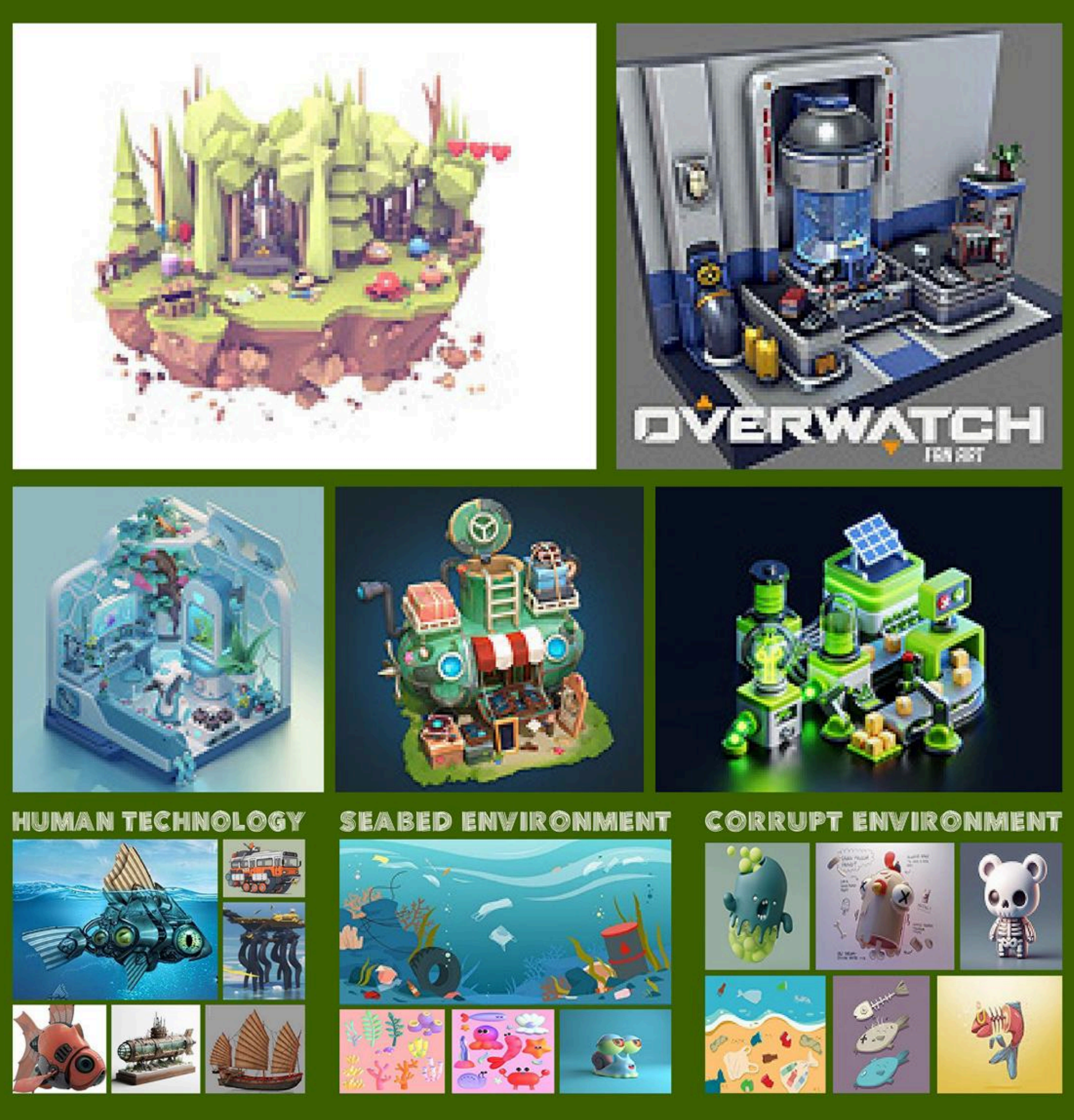
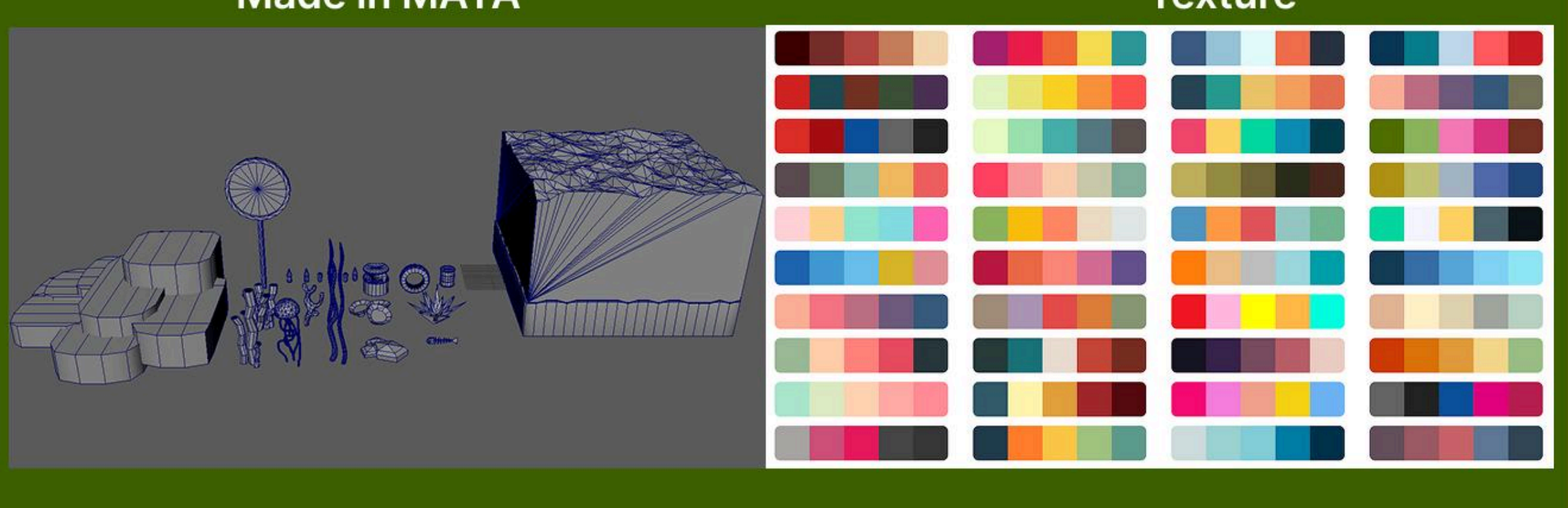


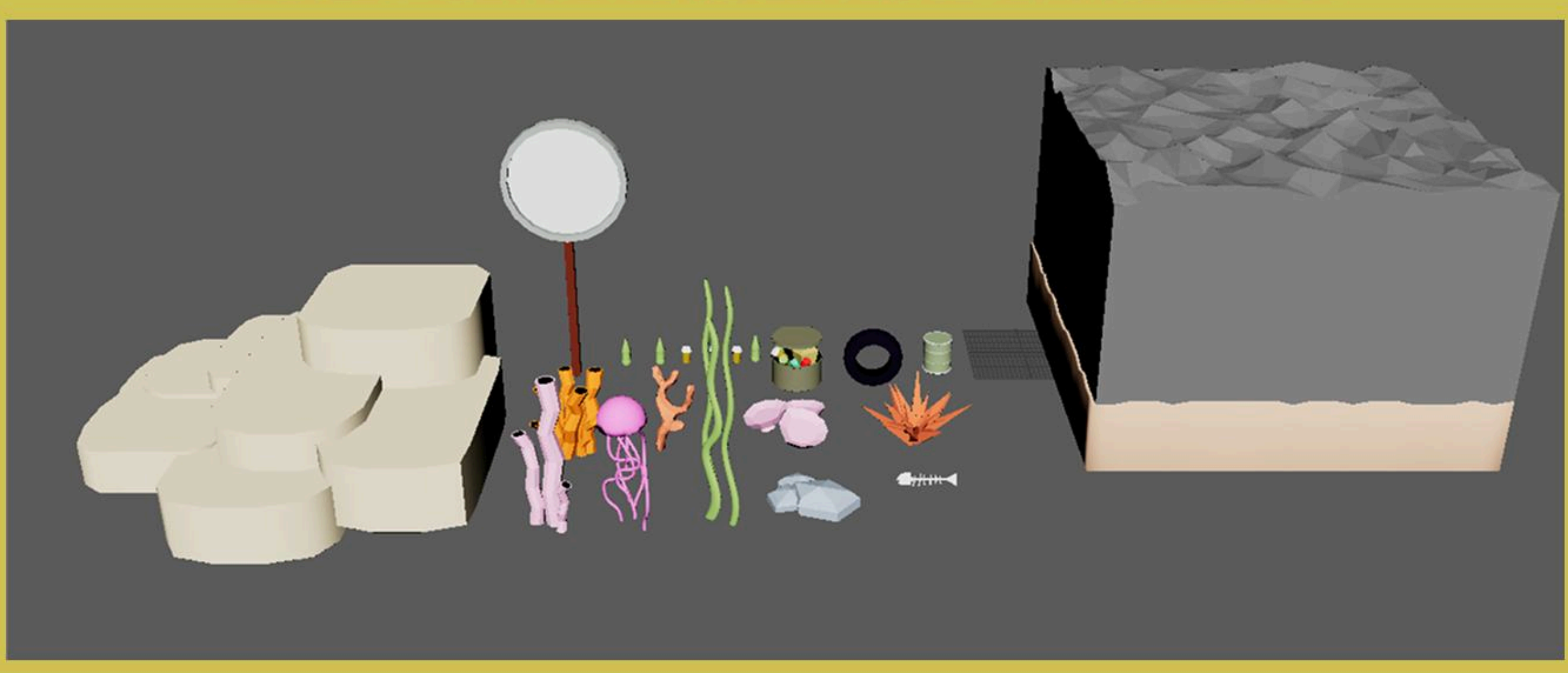
ENVRIONMENT MODELS

Made in MAYA

Texture



After expanding the UV, I used a large color palette to paint my model.
Because the models are all very simple, creating materials in substance painter would be kind of waste , so I used a single texture map with many colors and I just directly gave them the most basic solid colors.

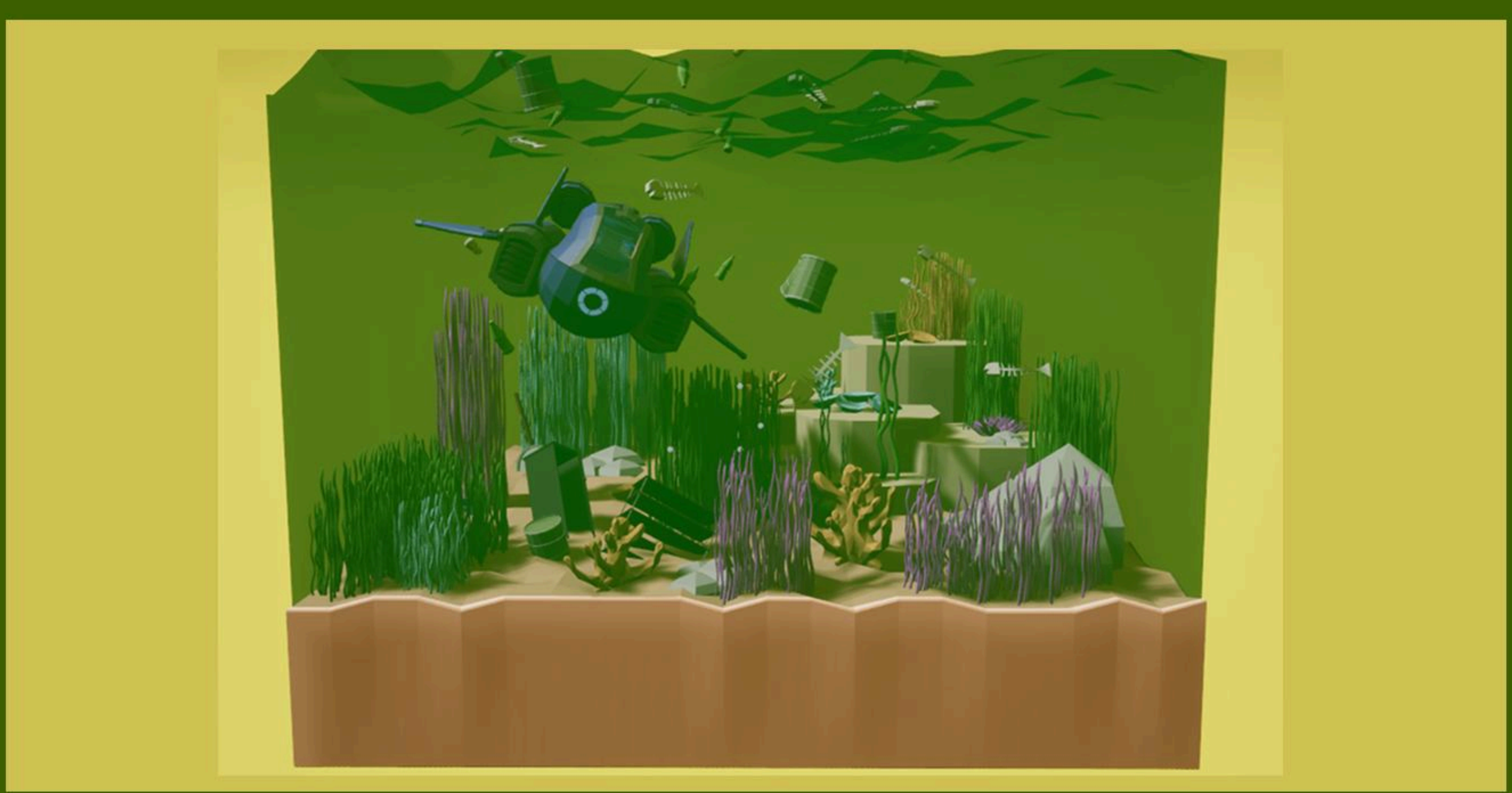


RENDERED IN UE5

All the assets

The interior of Oasis

FINAL RENDER



Finally, I imported all the models and textures into UE5 and completed the scene by copying and pasting them.

NATURE VS TRASH